

Reference Sheet for Exam 2

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13. Electric Field

Electric fields can be thought as a shared universal plane that is influenced by charges and influences charges, similar to gravity and mass.

13.1 Coulomb's Force Law for Point Particles

Describes the force behaviour that two charges experience.

$$|\vec{F}| = F = \frac{1}{4\pi\epsilon_0} \frac{|Q_1 Q_2|}{r^2}$$

13.3 Definition of Electric Field

This equation says that the force on particle 2 is determined by the charge of the particle 2 and by the electric field $\vec{E}_1$ made by all other charged particles.

$$\vec{F}_2 = q_2 \vec{E}_1$$

13.4 Electric Field of a Point Particle

This equation represents how the electric field is influenced due to a charge, with the use of calculus, it can be used to find the contributions of multiple electrical fields at a determinant point.

$$\vec{E}_1 = \frac{1}{4\pi\epsilon_0} \frac{q_1}{|\vec{r}|^2} \hat{r}$$

Continuous Charge Distributions

If we have objects in higher dimensions, the charge is distributed along them continuously.

- Linear Density (1D, for lines and curves), $\lambda = \frac{dQ}{dl}$ in (C/m) .
- Surface Density (2D, for planes and surface), $\sigma = \frac{dQ}{dA}$ in (C/m^2)
- Volume Density (3D, for solids and volumes), $\rho = \frac{dQ}{dV}$ in (C/m^3) .

Similarly to the total charge for a point is q , for the total charge of higher dimensional objects is the integral of the charge density times the dimensional measure.

$$Q = \int \lambda dl \quad Q = \int \sigma dA \quad Q = \int \rho dV$$

Electric Field from Continuous Distributions

Starting from a point-charge field replace dQ with the appropriate dimensional density.

$$d\vec{E} = \frac{1}{4\pi\epsilon_0} \frac{dQ}{r^2} \hat{r} \rightarrow \vec{E} = \frac{1}{4\pi\epsilon_0} \int \frac{dQ}{r^2} \hat{r}$$

Infinite Line of Charge (uniform λ)

$$E = \frac{\lambda}{2\pi\epsilon_0 r}$$

Ring of a Charge (uniform λ)

$$E = \frac{1}{4\pi\epsilon_0} \frac{Qr}{(r^2 + R^2)^{\frac{3}{2}}} \hat{r}$$

Note that R is the radius of the ring, r is the distance along the axis (perpendicular to the plane of the ring) from the center

Uniformly Charged Disk

In principle it can be calculated by making slices of the perimeter times the height dr and relating the distance of dr to the point to where the electric field will be evaluated.

$$E = \frac{\sigma}{2\epsilon_0} \left(1 - \frac{r}{\sqrt{r^2 + R^2}} \right)$$

Note that r is the distance along the axis of the disk

Infinite Plane

As $R \rightarrow \infty$ then:

$$E = \frac{\sigma}{2\epsilon_0}$$